

JEANNE

Siv? Siv, dear. We have notes.

(Richard reads further on.)

SIV

More notes? Do you know how much energy it takes to crosswalk eight decades? The sun is setting soon, we're losing the light. We don't have time for-

(Jeanne shoves the script in Siv's hands)

JEANNE

Siv, it's not acceptable. I don't gasp or bend one knee aloft or whatever these children have written.

(Siv reads the page closely)

SIV

I actually think this draft has some elements from your grandchildren so the story is obviously getting more muddled. Still, we don't have much time for any more-

RICHARD

Hey! My hats fit just fine. This is the style Siv, they need to change that.

(Siv and Jeanne share a look)

JEANNE

Dear, it's not been the style. Ever. I will say it seems our progeny are zappy.

RICHARD

Oh come on, not every conversation is a chance to show off your vocabulary Jeanne.

JEANNE

Maybe when you can fill out the crossword without a hint you can talk about it, but until then I prefer to call our progeny Z-A-P-P-Y.

SIV

Are you two sure this ends up in a marriage? Because you don't seem --

RICHARD

Yes. It does. End of story.

SIV

This story seems like it's never gonna end.

JEANNE

Remains to be seen. New script please Siv.

(Siv exits with a frustrated sigh. Richard weighs Jeanne's last comment)

RICHARD

What remains to be seen Jeanne? I know I'm not a snappy dresser or going to get you into picture openings, but I'll still take you places.

JEANNE

I know you would Dick, but-

RICHARD

But what dear?

(Jeanne sweetly straightens the fedora on Richard's head then points his gaze to the distance)

JEANNE

Look over there what do you see?

RICHARD

The Daniels and Fisher Tower. One of the tallest buildings west of the Mississippi, known for-

(Jeanne kisses him on the cheek and he looks back surprised)

RICHARD (CONT'D)

What was that for dear?

JEANNE

You will always see the building. That's what makes you who you are

RICHARD

Well what do you see?

JEANNE

I see blue gray mountains with
powdered sugar sprinkles on top. I
see the first turmeric-cinnamon
tinges of fall sneaking into the
edges of that oak tree. Over there
I see a mother wearing a bright
yellow coat pushing a navy blue
baby carriage past a red firetruck
and I want to paint it all Dicky.

RICHARD

You see all that?

JEANNE

Yes my dear.

(Richard notices something that catches his ear. Faintly in
the distance Clair de Lune plays)

RICHARD

Well what about that sound? Do you
hear it?

(Siv enters holding new scripts but doesn't speak or
interrupt)

JEANNE

Well, maybe. The piano tune?

RICHARD

Probably coming from the rotunda of
that hotel. It's Clair de Lune. I
can see the keys in front of me
now. Do you see them Jeanne?

JEANNE

No dear and that's the problem
isn't it.

(Richard considers the weight of her statement then, always
the optimist, counters in the only way he knows how.
Eureka!)

RICHARD

Opposites attract all the time
chemically speaking even.
Nucleophiles and-

SIV

She's right Richard. It's not a
perfect match.